NCCA ENTERTAINMENT

THE CAREGIVER'S SECRET

She was hired to care.
She was chosen to take the blame.

A domestic conspiracy thriller

Written by Kelly R. Tenney



The premise

A disgraced nurse takes a live-in job caring for a silenced former senator, then discovers the family that hired her chose her on purpose: her one bad mistake makes her the perfect person to blame.

Original movie / Domestic suspense / Atlanta setting

The audience’s way in

Dana needs this job to keep her family housed.

Eleanor needs someone to recognize that she is still there.

The woman paying Dana controls whose version of the truth survives.

An intimate alliance inside a house built to keep outsiders out.

The story

THE OFFER

Dana accepts a private-duty job at the Whitfield estate. Her patient’s fear contradicts the immaculate care records.

THE DISCOVERY

Eleanor begins to communicate. Dana uncovers diverted foundation money and a plan to make her the scapegoat.

THE CHOICE

With Eleanor’s transfer approaching and Luca within Priscilla’s reach, Dana must risk her future to keep her patient from disappearing.

Dana Reyes

34 / LPN / Single mother

She notices what everyone else has stopped seeing.

A false chart entry cost Dana her job and damaged her credibility. Now her employer intends to use that history against her.

Her journey: from protecting her livelihood through silence to protecting another woman by telling the truth.

Eleanor Whitfield

72 / Former senator / Whistleblower

Her voice is limited. Her will is not.

Once a public authority, Eleanor now depends on the people controlling her treatment. Her past contains a truth she would rather keep hidden.

A performance built through eyes, a left hand, and one determined thumb.

Priscilla Whitfield-Vance

Daughter / Foundation chair / Employer

She makes control look like care.

Priscilla offers Dana the help she needs, then turns that generosity into leverage. She knows how to manage a household, a donor, and a damaging account of events.

Her wound: a lifetime in her mother’s shadow.
Her choice: make her mother powerless.

The people around the bed

ADRIAN VANCE

The physician and husband whose professional authority sustains the deception. His final choice carries a cost.

MARGOT BELL

The housekeeper trapped by her son’s secret and years of obedience. Helping Dana means implicating herself.

ROSA & LUCA REYES

The family Dana is trying to protect. Their home and daily routines make the price of her courage tangible.

The suspense engine

Every act of communication changes the balance of power.

HELP	Dana recognizes the plea.
DON’T SIGN	Care records become evidence.
BOY FIRST	Eleanor protects her rescuer.
NO	Eleanor takes back the choice.

The world & tone

Buckhead privilege.
A patient behind a closed door.

Warm lamps and polished rooms conceal surveillance, coercion, and carefully maintained records.

The camera stays close to Dana and Eleanor. Suspense grows through withheld answers and small physical choices.

Moments that sell the film

The first plea	A broken glass. A hand on Dana's sleeve. "Help."
The impossible signature	A flowing signature on a document the patient could not have signed.
The blackout	One thumb holds an alarm down while the house tries to silence it.
The emotional turn	Eleanor sends Dana home to her son: "Boy first."

Audience & production approach

Positioned for the Lifetime / LMN domestic-thriller audience

A female-led story of betrayal inside the home, with a vulnerable patient and a mother who must trust her own judgment.

One primary estate anchors the film. Supporting locations include a care facility, family home, hospital, and school pickup area.

Performance-driven suspense. Limited physical action. Practical blackout sequence. Budget and schedule to be developed.

Casting possibilities

Creative wish list only. No attachments or outreach confirmed.

DANA REYES	Melissa Barrera / Diane Guerrero / Camila Mendes
ELEANOR WHITFIELD	Phylicia Rashad / Sissy Spacek / Lorraine Toussaint
PRISCILLA	Elizabeth Reaser / Tiffani Thiessen / Kelly Rutherford
ADRIAN VANCE	Scott Foley / Jason Priestley / Tim Daly
MARGOT BELL	Wendy Raquel Robinson / Kimberly Elise / Judy Reyes

Supporting cast possibilities

Creative wish list only. Availability and interest unverified.

ROSA REYES	Rosie Perez / Justina Machado / Angélica Aragón
KEZIA ADAMS	Sheryl Lee Ralph / Anika Noni Rose / Tonya Pinkins
LENA ORTIZ	Roselyn Sánchez / Aimee Garcia / Camille Guaty
THERESA HOLLIS	Yvonne Orji / Sufe Bradshaw / Gabrielle Dennis
LUCA, WALTER & RAY	Open child casting and a regional character-actor search

Under the Plate

A proposed eight-episode vertical companion

Before Dana, there was Theresa.

The prior caregiver’s story explores the same household from the woman who left it. Her experience leads into the opening of the feature.

Companion concept identified in the supplied package. Separate development and financing.



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A woman who listens can change everything.

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